December 16th, 2021

To Whom It May Concern,

As Senior Educator at the Environmental Learning Center (ELC) I had the pleasure of working with Ryan Coveny during his time as an ELC intern. Ryan served as an afterschool intern from December 2020 through May 2021 as part of his Biotechnology course at Vero Beach Senior High. Throughout this time Ryan served over 70 hours at the ELC. Although this was an unpaid position, Ryan treated his position with utmost professionalism.

As his primary responsibility, Ryan helped provide high-quality care for many species in our 1500-gallon aquaria. With just a few weeks of training, Ryan was able to quickly incorporate these new skills and perform tasks with little supervision. Work ranged from diet preparation and feeding, to conducting water quality tests, and performing water changes as needed.

In addition to performing routine aquaria care, Ryan spearheaded a project to convert paper-based data to a cloud-based spreadsheet – saving staff hours of work. As part of his internship, Ryan also created a slide show to help future ELC interns understand the nitrogen cycle and specifically, how that impacts water quality and animal health. ELC will be able to use this product for years to come.

As a small nature center, we sometimes wear many hats that require us to quickly change focus and even or planned daily work. At times this also impacted Ryan and he approached these challenges with patience and a helpful attitude, without fail.

Considering my experience working with Ryan, I have no doubt he will be successful in his future endeavors. Ryan is committed, hard-working, and has an internal drive to succeed.

Sincerely,

Sara Piotter
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